CASH TO COMPANY · GRADE 12

a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

The Workbook for the Year

Activities, sort tasks, and reflection prompts you'll keep.

Grade 12 year theme — Launch-Ready Entrepreneurship.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

9-12 BAND · HIGH SCHOOL

STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

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GRADE 12 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

The Workbook for the Year

Founder-defensible plans built on evidence, not enthusiasm.

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This is your book. You'll use it all year. There are no right answers and no wrong answers — only honest ones and dishonest ones, specific ones and vague ones. The honest, specific answer always wins.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"You can pick what kind of business you build. It's a choice."

By June, this book will be your portfolio. You'll be able to walk a panel through it in thirty minutes and leave with a Launch-or-Learn decision you can defend. That's the point. You're not learning about entrepreneurship. You're being one for nine months and seeing what you find out about yourself when the year is done.

A note on the rule that holds this whole year: **which people, and how do you know?** Every claim you write here will get that question. Every claim other students write here will get it from you. Get used to it. By Week 8 it will be reflex. By June, it will be a tool you carry into the rest of your life.

Unit 1 — Portfolio thinking and the founder's journal

> "What would have to be true for you to be wrong?"
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

Activity 1.1 — Three Doors

Imagine three doors. Behind each is a year of your life running a different venture. Describe each door — specifically. "A clothing brand" doesn't count. "A custom-fit t-shirt service for college freshmen at the local university who want one high-quality moving-in shirt" counts.

Door 1 — The venture I'd most like to run:

- Customer (specific people, one behavior — not just a demographic): _____
- What they want or are frustrated by: _____
- How you'd reach them: _____
- Smallest version you could test in 4 weeks: _____
- What would have to be true for it to work: _____
- What you'd bring (founder-market fit): _____

Door 2 — The venture that scares me a little:

- Customer: _____
- What they want: _____
- How you'd reach them: _____
- Smallest version: _____
- What would have to be true: _____
- What you'd bring: _____

Door 3 — The venture I'd run if I had to pick the safest one:

- Customer: _____
- What they want: _____
- How you'd reach them: _____
- Smallest version: _____
- What would have to be true: _____
- What you'd bring: _____

Activity 1.2 — The Door I'm Walking Through

Pick one door. Write 6-8 sentences. Make sure two of those sentences answer this question: Why this door, and not the other two? Reasons must be grounded in market, fit, or capital — not "I just like it more."

My choice:

Activity 1.3 — Premortem

It is December of next year. Your venture is dead. Write the failure story in past tense. Be specific. Vague failure stories don't help you.

Imagined Future (one paragraph, past tense):

Top three causes of the failure:

1.
2.
3.

The most likely cause: _____

One specific action I'm taking this month to mitigate it:

Activity 1.4 — Founder's Journal Entry #1

This is the first of at least 10 entries you'll write this year. Use the four prompts. Keep entries specific and short (one paragraph each is fine). The point is the discipline, not the word count.

Date: ___

1. What evidence did I gather this week? (Counts. Quotes. Screenshots. Observations. Not feelings.)

2. What did I change my mind about? (If nothing changed, write that — and write why you're worried.)

3. What's the most fragile assumption right now? (The thing where if you're wrong, the venture cracks.)

4. What am I doing next week? (One or two specific moves.)

Reflection prompt — End of Unit 1

In one paragraph: What did Unit 1 surface that I didn't know about myself or my venture in Week 1?

Unit 2 — The full financial pack

Activity 2.1 — Three Statements, Three Questions

Match the founder question to the statement that answers it.

Founder asks...	Best answered by...
"Am I profitable?"	___
"Am I going to run out of money?"	___
"What do I own and owe?"	___

Your one-sentence definition of each statement (in your own words):

- **P&L: _____**
- **Cash flow: _____**
- **Balance sheet: _____**

Activity 2.2 — Reading Two Sample Packs

Your teacher will give you two sample financial packs (one venture that succeeded, one that didn't). Answer for each:

Pack A:

- Profitable in Year 1? ___
- Negative ending cash in any month? Which month? ___
- Largest expense category: ___
- Would you have invested? Why? _____

Pack B:

- Profitable in Year 1? ___
- Negative ending cash in any month? Which month? ___
- Largest expense category: ___
- Would you have invested? Why? _____

One sentence on what these two packs taught you: _____

Activity 2.3 — Your Unit Economics

Compute the three numbers for your Capstone venture. Use a spreadsheet for the arithmetic; record results here.

- **Price per unit (or per customer):** $___
- **Variable cost per unit:** $___
- **Contribution margin per customer:** $___

Customer acquisition cost (CAC, simplified):

Hours of your time spent acquiring 1 customer × $15/hour: $___

Plus money spent (ads, samples, travel): $___

Total CAC: $___

Lifetime value (LTV, simplified):

Contribution margin × expected number of repeat purchases: $___

LTV / CAC ratio: ___

Read the ratio. Above 3? Healthy. 1-3? Tight. Below 1? Dangerous.

Activity 2.4 — The Downside Scenario

Build the same picture with two changes: CAC at 2× and contribution margin at 0.8×.

- **New CAC:** $___
- **New contribution margin:** $___
- **New LTV / CAC ratio:** ___

Sensitivity sentence. Complete this:

"My venture's economics break if __ is wrong by more than __ percent. The single input I'm most uncertain about is __, and the way I'd test it this month is __."

Activity 2.5 — Founder's Journal Entry #4

Same four prompts as before. Three months in. What's different?

Reflection prompt — End of Unit 2

Money things I now understand that I didn't in September:

Money things I still find confusing:

Unit 3 — Launch, brand, and compliance

Activity 3.1 — The 5-of-5 Conversation Tracker

You'll have 5 real conversations with people who are not in this classroom. Plan the 5 here. List a specific person, a specific relationship, and a specific channel.

#	Person (or relationship if name is private)	Relationship	Channel	Status	Date	One surprising thing they said
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						

The 5-question protocol:

1. Tell me about the last time you ___ (the situation your venture is about).
2. What was hard about it?
3. What did you do?
4. What would have been ideal?
5. Would you tell me one more story like that?

After each conversation, write within 24 hours:

- The most surprising thing they said.
- One claim about my customer that I now have to revise.

Activity 3.2 — Brand One-Pager

Pull this together in one page. Don't over-design. Substance, not slick.

- **Venture name: ___**
- **Tagline (one sentence, customer-facing): ___**

- **Customer (specific): ___**
- **What we do (in their words): ___**
- **Color and feel (3 words): ___**
- **What we will not say or do: ___**

Activity 3.3 — Landing Page Checklist

Build and publish a landing page. Use Carrd, Notion, or another school-approved tool. Required sections:

- [ ] Headline that names the customer or the problem in their words.
- [ ] One-sentence description of what you do.
- [ ] One CTA (call to action) — what's the one thing you want a visitor to do?
- [ ] Contact form or email link.
- [ ] Honest disclosure (you are a student venture; how payments are handled if they are; privacy basics).

My landing page URL: ___

One thing I'd test next on the landing page: ___

Activity 3.4 — Compliance Checklist

For each item, mark Done · In Progress · Not Applicable, with a note.

Item	Status	Note
Structure choice (sole prop / LLC / other)		
Sales tax (state registration if required)		
Terms of service (1-page version)		
Privacy basics (what you collect; how you handle it)		
Payment safety (which processor, what data you store)		
Insurance (small-business coverage if needed)		

My one-sentence honest disclosure for the landing page:

Activity 3.5 — Founder's Journal Entry #7

Reflection prompt — End of Unit 3

The most surprising thing I learned from a real customer this unit:

The compliance item I almost skipped, and the reason I didn't:

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 12

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

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Unit 4 — Operating, leading, and the Launch-or-Learn defense

> **"I don't know either. That's why we test."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

Activity 4.1 — The 90-Day Plan

Build 12 weeks of plan. One row per week. Be specific about priorities — "build the website" is not a priority; "publish the landing page with one CTA and a working contact form" is.

Week	Priority (one sentence)	Owner	Metric	Target	Actual (fill at week's end)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					

Activity 4.2 — Weekly Variance Report (4 of these)

You'll fill four of these — Weeks 31, 32, 33, 34. The point is honesty, not optimism.

Week #__:

- Planned: ___
- Actual: ___
- Variance (status: green / yellow / red, and why): ___
- Root cause (specific — not "I was busy"): ___
- Adjustment for next week: ___

Activity 4.3 — The Founder's Leadership Statement

One page. Four sections. Specific, not aspirational.

Values (3-5 — each with one sentence of what this looks like in practice):

1.
2.
3.
4.
5.

Decision rules (3-5 — format: "When , I , because __"):

1.
2.
3.

How I show up as a teammate (and the weakness I'm working on):

One thing I won't do:

Activity 4.4 — The Launch-or-Learn Decision

This is the most important sentence you will write this year. It is the heart of your Capstone Defense.

My Launch-or-Learn decision is: ☐ Launch · ☐ Pivot · ☐ Shelve

The evidence behind it (3-5 specific things):

1.
2.
3.

4.
5.

What I considered and rejected:

My personal next step:

Activity 4.5 — Capstone Defense Outline (10 slides)

Outline your Defense slides here. One sentence per slide. Don't write a script — write a structure.

1. **Customer: ___**
2. **Evidence: ___**
3. **Financial pack — P&L: ___**
4. **Financial pack — cash flow + runway: ___**
5. **Brand and 5 conversations: ___**
6. **Compliance: ___**
7. **90-day plan and variance: ___**
8. **Leadership statement (3-sentence version): ___**
9. **Launch-or-Learn decision: ___**
10. **One thing I learned about myself: ___**

Activity 4.6 — Founder's Journal Entries #8–#10

Three more entries. Same four prompts. By the end of these, you should have at least 10 entries in your journal across the year, and one of them should document a real pivot (or a real decision not to pivot, with reasoning).

Entry #8 date: _ _____

Entry #9 date: _ _____

Entry #10 date: _ _____

Final reflection — End of Year

Write 2-3 paragraphs. The reflection criteria are: specificity of self-observation, evidence of revised thinking, honest naming of difficulty, forward-looking specificity, and your own voice.

What I learned about myself this year that I didn't know in September:

The hardest thing this year — named honestly, not performed:

What I'm doing next — beyond this venture, in this venture, or instead of it:

Reference — Cash's questions you'll get all year

When in doubt, your work should answer one of these. If it doesn't, you're not done yet.

- Which people, and how do you know?
- What does your evidence tell you?
- What would have to be true for you to be right?
- What would have to be true for you to be wrong?
- Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. What's yours?
- Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next.
- Tell me what they actually said.
- A little less wrong, every week.
- Don't sell. Show.

Reference — Vocabulary roadmap

You'll need these by Defense Day. Definitions kept short on purpose; deeper meaning comes from how you use them in your venture.

- **Venture portfolio.** A structured comparison of two or more business ideas, used to decide where to invest your time.
- **Founder's journal.** Your weekly written record of evidence, beliefs revised, and next moves planned. At least 10 entries by Week 36, and one explicit pivot or kill decision documented.
- **Premortem.** Imagine the venture has already failed twelve months from now. Work backward to identify why. Past tense. Specific.
- **Opportunity cost.** What you give up by choosing one thing over another. The year you would have spent on Door 1, you can't also spend on Door 2.
- **Founder-market fit (simplified).** The match between who you are — your background, network, interests — and what the market needs.
- **P&L (income statement).** Revenue minus expenses over a period. Answers: am I profitable?
- **Cash flow statement.** Cash in and cash out over a period. Answers: am I going to run out of money?
- **Balance sheet.** A snapshot at a moment in time of what you own, what you owe, and the difference.
- **Three-statement consistency.** When the P&L, cash flow, and balance sheet tie to each other arithmetically.
- **Runway.** How many months you can operate at current burn before you run out of cash.
- **Burn rate.** How much cash you're using up per month.
- **Unit economics.** The revenue and cost picture for one customer or one unit of sale.
- **Contribution margin.** Price minus variable cost. What's left to pay fixed costs and put in your pocket.
- **CAC (simplified).** Customer acquisition cost. All time and money spent acquiring one customer.
- **LTV (simplified).** Lifetime value. Contribution margin × expected number of repeat purchases. Healthy ratio: LTV > 3× CAC.
- **Sensitivity.** How much the result changes when one input changes.
- **MVP.** Minimum viable product. The smallest version of your venture that can give you a real signal.
- **Landing page.** A single web page describing what you do, with one clear CTA.
- **Sole proprietorship.** Default unincorporated structure for a single-owner business. The owner is personally liable.
- **LLC.** A more protective structure that separates personal and business liability.

- **Sales tax nexus (basics).** The threshold at which a state can require you to collect sales tax. Varies by state.
- **Terms of service.** The contract between you and your customer.
- **90-day plan.** A 12-week-ahead operating plan with weekly priorities, owners, and metrics.
- **Weekly variance.** The difference between what was planned and what actually happened. Reported honestly.
- **Leadership statement.** A 1-page personal document naming your values and decision rules.
- **Launch-or-Learn decision.** Your final, defended choice for the Capstone venture: launch, pivot, or shelve.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 12

"Most adults skip t step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

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Reference — Sample evidence quality scale

> **“Some of this is hard because the world's hard. The skill is knowing what's in your hands.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 12

When you write an evidence claim, ask yourself which row this is on. The rule: show, don't tell.

Quality	What it looks like	What to do with it
1 — Hearsay	"I heard people would buy this."	Doesn't count. Go get a quote, count, or screenshot.
2 — Single anecdote	"My friend said she'd buy it."	One data point. Useful only with 2+ more.
3 — Pattern	"Three of five people I asked described the same frustration."	This is a real signal. Build on it.
4 — Behavioral evidence	"Two people pre-ordered. One asked when the next batch ships."	The strongest evidence at this stage of the venture.

A closing word

This is your last year in the program. By Defense Day you'll have done the work most adults skip — comparing options, building a financial pack, talking to real people, writing a 90-day plan, naming your decision rules, and making a defended call about whether to launch.

That's not nothing. That's most of what running anything serious requires. You'll use these moves in college, in jobs, in volunteer roles, in your own ventures someday. The book in your hands is the proof that you can.

Make it honest. Make it specific. Make it yours.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 12)

Practice A — Three-statement consistency check

Build the three statements for your Capstone venture. Verify they agree.

P&L (annual):

Line	Amount
Revenue	
COGS	
Gross margin	
Operating expenses	
Net income	

Cash flow forecast (12 months):

Month	Cash in	Cash out	Ending cash
1			
...			
12			

Balance sheet sketch (end of year 1):

Assets	Liabilities + Equity
Cash	Accounts payable
Inventory	Loans (if any)
Equipment	Owner's equity
Total assets	**Total L+E**

Consistency check: Cash on balance sheet = Cash flow ending Month 12. Equity = starting equity + net income from P&L. Verify.

Practice B — Runway and burn

Compute runway:

Cash on hand: $__ **Monthly cash in: $_ Monthly cash out: $ Net monthly burn: $ Runway (months): ___**

What do you do at month __ if no new revenue? ____

Practice C — Three contract drafts

Pick one of each:

1. **Service agreement** (if you offer services). Use the template from Lesson 7. Fill all 5 elements.
2. **Mutual NDA** (if you might partner). Use the template. Fill all 5 elements.
3. **Terms of service** (if you have a platform). Write the 5 key elements as bullet points (full TOS is too long for this practice — bullet points show you understand the structure).

Practice D — First-90-days checklist (if you're choosing LAUNCH)

Item	Status	Notes
Entity registered (or decided to remain sole prop)	☐	
Business bank account opened	☐	
Sales tax nexus researched	☐	
Bookkeeping rhythm scheduled (Sunday 5 min?)	☐	
Customer feedback loop active	☐	
First contract template ready	☐	
Personal runway named (months)	☐	

Practice E — Launch-or-Learn statement (the year's anchor)

5 paragraphs:

Paragraph 1: My decision. _____

Paragraph 2: The evidence behind it. _____

Paragraph 3: What I would have to be wrong about. _____

Paragraph 4: What I learned regardless of the decision. _____

Paragraph 5: My next step. _____

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 12 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“Founder-defensible plans built on evidence, not enthusiasm.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 12**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).